

'Produce,' Yank Scouts Told as Talent Slows

The "break up the Yankees" cry that has been heard so often over the

Baseball Scrapbook

by
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years has been stilled. There is a feeling now that it won't be necessary.

Even if they should come back to win the current world series, they still will need help to keep rolling. Their "old pros" are nearing the end of the line and replacements are not in sight; the once gushing well of talent seems to be drying up.

The Yankees had to cut off Denver's working agreement because they lacked the players to stock two triple A clubs and those in the know say the Yanks haven't more than four players in the entire system who figure to eventually help the big club.

The Yankees had an organization meeting at the Series in Milwaukee last week. The scouts got the order: "Start producing."

Incidentally, Denver's new working agreement most likely will be with the Chicago Cubs.

ANDY COHEN rates an assist in the development of Billy Bruton, who is having such a hot series

for Milwaukee, according to Denver scribe Frank Haraway.

"Andy had Bruton at Eau Claire in 1950," Haraway recalls. "Billy was tremendously fast but all he could do was run. He didn't look like a prospect either at the bat or in the field. Other managers in the Braves' system didn't want him but Andy, moving up to handle the Denver Western league club for the Braves, saw his possibilities.

"And under Andy's tutoring in 1951 Billy developed fast, his fielding improved greatly and he hit over .300. Then it was a season at Milwaukee in the AA and up to the majors to stay. By the way, Bruton is listed as 29 on the roster but his real age is 33."

BOB COLEMAN, patriarch of the Braves' system, has been one of Warren Spahn's chief admirers ever since he had the great left-hander at Evansville (Three I) in 1941. Coleman, by the way, says "Minneapolis in the playoffs and Little World Series was the hottest club I ever saw. They could have beaten anyone."

CARL HUBBELL says the biggest need of the surprising New York Giants for 1959 is one top-notch pitcher. "We need that 'stopper,' the guy who can

win that big first game of the tough series," Hub points out. "Johnny Antonelli and Ruben Gomez couldn't do it this season, and that hurt. We've got a lot of good trading stock, but it won't be easy to make the big deal."

Yesterday's swapping of Marv Grissom and Ernie Broglio to the Cardinals for Billy Muffett, Hobie Landrith and Benny Valenzuela does not fall in the "big deal" category.

MOVIE STAR Jeff Chandler was a smash, literally, in a hotel coffee shop during the series in Milwaukee. A waitress with a loaded tray turned to look as the tall actor strode into the restaurant — and dropped the tray right on the head of a patron.

